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UPDATES



Trails of smoke during Israeli shelling on the outskirts of the village of Yohmor in Lebanon on Sunday, as seen from the southern area of Marjayoun.

AFP

TRUMP REJECTS IRAN TERMS, SAYS TRUCE ON LIFE SUPPORT

Oil jumps, Europe weighs maritime mission

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.

Senior Associate Editor

Pressure continued to build on Iran yesterday after US President Donald Trump rejected Tehran's latest response to Washington's ceasefire proposal, calling it "totally unacceptable" and accusing Iran of "playing games".

Trump also added that the US-Iran ceasefire was on "massive life support" as the two sides failed to agree terms to start talks on ending their war. "The ceasefire is on massive life support, where the doctor walks in and says, 'Sir, your loved one has approximately a one per cent chance of living,'" Trump said.

Trump's remarks underscored widening differences between the two sides despite weeks of backchannel diplomacy aimed at ending the war and reopening the Strait of Hormuz. Iranian state media said Tehran's proposal focused on ending the war, lifting sanctions, releasing frozen Iranian assets and ending the US naval blockade before any broader concessions.

Iran warns of retaliation

Iran's foreign ministry defended the proposal as "reasonable" and "generous". Spokesman Esmail Baqaei said Tehran had sought "an end to the war in the region", the lifting of restrictions on Iranian oil exports and the release of assets "un-



Iran has been playing games with the United States, and the rest of the World, for 47 years... They will be laughing no longer, Trump said.

justly trapped in foreign banks". Iran also warned it would retaliate against any renewed US strikes and would not permit additional foreign warships in the Strait of Hormuz, highlighting the fragility of the ceasefire.

The US military has meanwhile maintained a blockade on Iranian ports since April 13, claiming it has turned back 61 commercial vessels and disabled four.

Regional tensions remained high after Gulf states condemned fresh drone activity linked to Iran. Bahrain and Saudi Arabia denounced attacks targeting the UAE, Qatar and Kuwait, calling them threats to regional security and stability.

Diplomatic contacts

At the same time, Iran and Saudi Arabia continued diplomatic contacts. Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi and Saudi Foreign Minister Faisal Bin Farhan held their second phone call in 24 hours as efforts continued to prevent wider regional escalation.

The EU's foreign policy chief said the bloc will boost ties to the GCC countries of the UAE, Qatar, Bahrain, Kuwait, Oman

and Saudi Arabia. "We will accelerate our work regarding the strategic partnership agreements with all six Gulf countries ... and we are ready to frontload our security and defence cooperation," Kaja Kallas said. She added the ceasefire is "under heavy strain" in the Strait of Hormuz amid Iranian firings on countries in the region.

Oil prices climbed in Asian trading after Trump's rejection raised fears of renewed disruption to energy flows through Hormuz.

Mounting global risks

The UN also warned of mounting global risks, saying fertiliser blockades through the strait could push another 45 million people into hunger and starvation within weeks.

Meanwhile, Britain and France said they would host a multinational meeting of defence ministers today to discuss restoring maritime security and trade flows through Hormuz amid continuing attacks on shipping.

Tensions also persisted in Lebanon, where Israeli strikes continued despite a truce with Hezbollah. Regional analyst Maha Yahya warned the conflict was fuelling support for the Iran-backed group and increasing polarisation inside Lebanon.

Inside Iran, pressure is also growing economically. Internet monitoring group NetBlocks said Iran's wartime internet blackout entered its 73rd day yesterday.

SEE ALSO P4, 9, 10, 11, 12

Abu Dhabi's Dh42b push for smart, green future

New infrastructure, housing and transport projects improve quality of life

ABU DHABI

BY ALI AL HAMMADI

Reporter

200+

parks and sports facilities, 24 schools, 21 mosques and 28 community councils part of the projects

Abu Dhabi continues to strengthen its position as a global model for sustainable urban development and quality of life through a series of major projects focused on infrastructure, smart mobility, sustainability and urban expansion.

According to figures released by the Department of Municipalities and Transport, the emirate allocated Dh42 billion for new infrastructure and community projects, while nearly 190,000 housing units were approved.

The department said 2025 marked a major step in Abu Dhabi's institutional development journey, with new programmes introduced to improve operational efficiency and government services across Abu Dhabi, Al Ain and Al Dhafra.

60+ development projects

As part of efforts to improve quality of life, more than 60 development projects worth Dh12 billion were completed under the Lifestyle Strategy.

The projects included more than 200 parks and sports facilities, 24 schools, 21 mosques and 28 community councils. Au-

thorities also developed 120 kilometres of walking tracks and 283 kilometres of cycling lanes across the emirate. Officials said several new community facilities and parks are also planned, including 16 parks in Al Shamkha.

The department approved around 75 million square metres of gross floor area for development during the year, representing annual growth of 137 per cent. The approved projects include more than 158,000 residential units for the real estate market and around 30,000 homes for UAE nationals.

Authorities also launched the AI-powered "Binaa" digital platform to improve regulatory services and support faster project approvals. As part of Abu Dhabi's digital transformation efforts, smart tracking systems and AI-powered cameras were installed across the department's vehicle fleet to improve operational performance.

In sustainable transport, the Integrated Transport Centre continued expanding environmentally friendly mobility solutions.

SEE ALSO P7

WORLD

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ENTERTAINMENT

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Etihad Rail launches safety campaign

Future passengers, communities and road users to be engaged

DUBAI

BY ANUPAM VARMA

News and Business Editor

Etihad Rail, the developer and operator of the UAE's national railway network, has launched a nationwide rail safety campaign, marking a significant step in preparation for the introduction of passenger services across the country.

The campaign aims to raise

awareness of safe behaviour around railway infrastructure, and will be delivered through a multi-channel approach, including broadcast, digital, and community engagement initiatives, reaching audiences across all emirates.

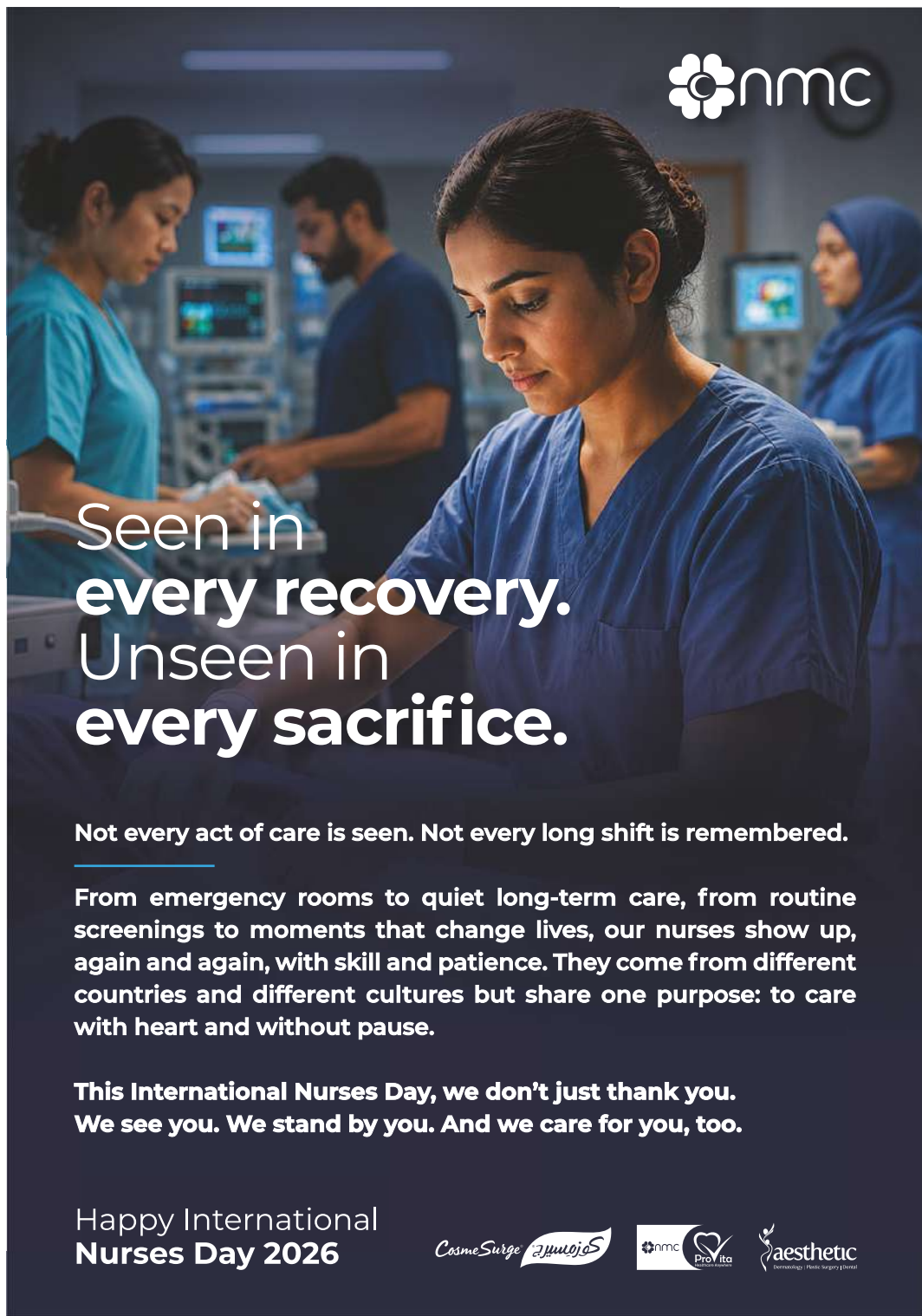
Critical role

The campaign will play a critical role in ensuring that communities, road users, and future passengers understand how to interact safely with the railway environment. The campaign is grounded in a clear strategic principle: safety is not a stan-

dalone message, but a long-term cultural commitment.

At the heart of the campaign is a simple but powerful positioning: safety is care. By anchoring safety in a value deeply understood across the UAE, the campaign reframes responsibility as something shared between individuals, communities, and the wider system.

Through clear, calm and human messaging, it aims to encourage awareness, promote positive intervention, and build a culture in which safe behaviour becomes instinctive over time.





Seen in every recovery. Unseen in every sacrifice.

Not every act of care is seen. Not every long shift is remembered.

From emergency rooms to quiet long-term care, from routine screenings to moments that change lives, our nurses show up, again and again, with skill and patience. They come from different countries and different cultures but share one purpose: to care with heart and without pause.

This International Nurses Day, we don't just thank you. We see you. We stand by you. And we care for you, too.

Happy International Nurses Day 2026

